

December: Microsoft Buys Hotmail

Hotmail was acquired by Microsoft for \$400 million (Rs 1,800 crore). At the time, there were about 8.5 million Hotmail users. Hotmail's infrastructure, which was Solaris-based, continued to power the site till the end of the millennium.

1998: Goooooooooogle

February: Open Source

The term "Open Source" was coined. The Open Source Initiative was formed by Bruce Perens and Eric Raymond as an alternative to Richard Stallman's Free Software Foundation. Open source software licensing terms are not as restrictive as those of the Free Software Foundation's GPL (GNU Public License). Open source licensing allowed software that was not entirely free to be used along with free software, which was something the FSF did not permit. Netscape's browser code was made open source, but was not licensed under the GPL. The launch of OSI coincided with the opening up of Netscape's code.

May: Pretty Apples

Apple Computer began shipping the iMac G3 (this was the first iMac, despite the "G3" connotation). Designed by Jonathan Ive, the iMac had just three sub-units—the monitor, the keyboard, and the mouse. The components that usually constitute the cabinet in the ordinary PC were incorporated into the iMac's monitor. It was the first Desktop computer to do away with a floppy drive, and the first Macintosh to use USB. The "i" in iMac referred to the Internet, since Apple wanted to emphasise the ease with which a user could go online with the iMac. It was powered by a 233 MHz Power PC 750 processor.



The Pretty iMac